TASK – 5

PART A : Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud (Real Incident-Based)

UPI fraud is a growing cybercrime in India where scammers misuse digital payment systems to steal money from users. A real case reported in Delhi involved fraudsters carrying out a ₹20 lakh UPI scam by gaining unauthorized access to victims' banking apps and transferring money without consent.

In a typical scenario, the fraud happens step-by-step. First, the victim either receives a fake call/message or loses access to their phone. In this case, scammers used stolen mobile phones to access banking apps. Next, they bypass security or trick the user into revealing details like OTP or UPI PIN. Once access is gained, multiple transactions are quickly made through UPI apps. Sometimes, fraudsters also use fake payment links or QR codes, where users think they are receiving money but actually approve a payment instead.

Such crimes usually target students, elderly people, or anyone who is not very aware of digital security. With the rapid increase in digital payments, these frauds are also rising—over 13 lakh UPI fraud cases were reported in a single year in India.

The consequences can be serious, including loss of money, mental stress, and misuse of personal data.

This case highlights the importance of staying alert while using UPI. Users should never share their PIN or OTP and must always verify payment requests carefully.

PART – B

A. Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

- Never share your **UPI PIN, OTP, or bank details** with anyone—even if they claim to be from your bank.
- Always **verify payment requests** before accepting them; remember, receiving money does NOT require entering your PIN.
- Avoid clicking on **unknown links** sent via SMS, email, or WhatsApp.
- Use **strong and unique passwords** for all accounts and enable **2-factor authentication (2FA)**.
- Download apps only from **trusted sources** like Google Play Store or App Store.
- Regularly **update your apps and phone software** to fix security issues.
- Do not connect to **public Wi-Fi for banking or payments**.
- Check URLs carefully before logging in—fake websites often look real.
- Log out from shared devices and **never save passwords on public systems**.
- Be cautious while sharing personal information on social media.

B. Report cybercrime immediately:

- National Cyber Crime Portal: **https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- Helpline Number: **1930**